

The Library Book Portal Submarine

A bit of a stretch · Indoors · Grown-up nearby · Ages 6–10 · 40 min

Brought to you by Yuna — “Every good adventure starts on a page.”

Read one page about the ocean, then build the submarine that takes you down into it.

WHAT YOU NEED

- A book about the sea
- A shoebox or similar
- Bottle caps, buttons, and lids for dials
- Tape and glue
- Clear packaging plastic for a porthole

BEFORE YOU START

A grown-up cuts the porthole hole.

Keep small parts away from anyone under three.

How to make it

- 1 Read one page about the ocean and pick a single fact that surprised you.
- 2 Cut a round porthole in the side of the box and tape clear plastic behind it.
- 3 Build a control panel on the inside: dials from bottle caps, switches from folded card, one big lever.
- 4 Label one control after the fact you found. If your fact was about depth, build a depth gauge.
- 5 Draw what is outside the porthole on a strip of paper, and slide it past the window like a film.
- 6 Take somebody on a dive. Narrate what they see and work your fact into the journey.

TALK ABOUT IT

Which fact from the book made you want to look something else up?

TRY THIS TOO

Swap the ocean for space, a cave, or the inside of a volcano. The submarine becomes a different vehicle entirely.

DID YOU KNOW? · NATURE & ANIMALS

An octopus has three hearts. Two hearts push blood to the gills, where it picks up oxygen, and the third pushes it round the rest of the body. When an octopus swims, the third heart stops, which is one reason octopuses would usually rather crawl.